



PANDO

A platform for ALL

March 28th 2025



Why PANDO?



Pando is the name of a quaking aspen the largest tree in the world, and is essentially a colony of identical stems which originate from a common root. The name roughly translates to “I spread” in Latin.

We feel this is emblematic of our goal to facilitate connectivity and raise awareness about the environmental movement. .

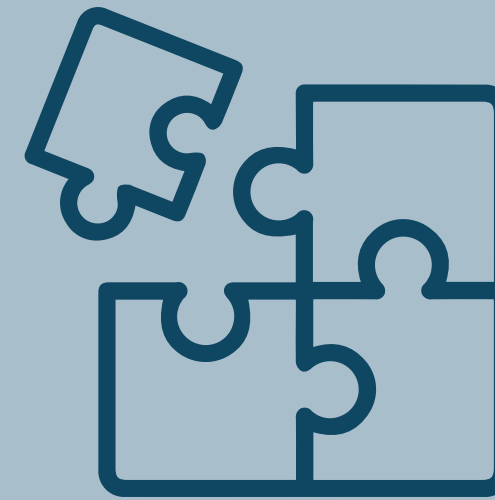


PANDO Objectives



Mission Statement

- Create a space for individuals to share and access accurate information about the environment.
- Inspire environmental activism among local and global communities.



Vision Statement

- We help foster an inclusive and engaged community of well-informed climate activists.

Values

Education

- Sharing factual information and global news stories to give users a critical, multi-perspectival understanding of the climate crisis.
- Through the Hope Hub, users can tell their own stories and share tips for living more sustainably.



- Users can subscribe to topics they relate to most, avoiding vast, overwhelming amounts of information.

Hope

- Inspires Action by opposing climate defeatism with optimism and real progress.
 - Aiming to counteract the overwhelming, disheartening nature of climate news.
 - User-driven forum for exchanging success stories.
 - Tracking real progress happening in the world through petitions, local initiatives and goal tracking.
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Values

Accessibility

- Prioritizes access to environmental knowledge for all users, regardless of background
- Designed for low-bandwidth and data-limited environments (Hjorth & Hinton, 2019)
- Follows WCAG guidelines with screen reader and keyboard navigation support (W3C, 2023)
- Uses decentralized, open-source systems to resist censorship (Shilina, 2023)
- Supports multilingual access to include non-English-speaking activists (Ginsburg, 2024)
- Accessibility is a core design principle—not just a feature

Collaboration

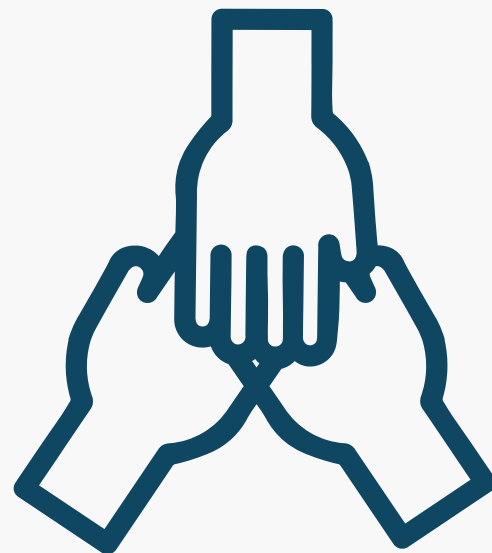
- Collective problems require collective solutions.
- Antithetical to the neoliberal agenda which focuses on individualism.
- All movements require collaboration between various groups, especially since the climate movements intersects with many other social movements (indigenous rights, ecofeminism etc.)



Values

Action/Empowerment

- **Interactive Challenges & Gamification** – Encourages sustainable habits.
- **Clear Calls to Action** – Petitions, policy advocacy, community initiatives.
- **Fact-Checking & Moderation Tools** – Fights misinformation.



- **Event Maps** – Climate strikes, cleanups, conservation events near users.
- **Volunteer & Networking Opportunities** – Connect with organizations & movements.
- **Collaboration Tools** – Coordinate and track community sustainability projects.
- **Transparency** – Sponsorship and funding disclosures.
- **Accessibility Features** – Multilingual options, offline content.
- **Educational Partnerships** – Credible info via NGOs and institutions.

Information



Audience

Our audience is anyone over +14 years old. Those under 18 years old will have more moderation.

Gaps

Enabling passive engagement.
Endless streams of information.
Little to no moderation.



Needs it is meeting:

- Emphasizes action over passive engagement.
 - More tailored dissemination of information.
 - More stringent moderation practices to minimize misinformation and create a safe space for everyone.
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Core Features

News and Events

- This forum allows users to post news, information etc.
- Information is moderated and users are required to post sources to support their information
- Users can also post about protests/organizing initiatives to raise awareness and increase participation

Hope Hub

- This forum will serve as a space for users to post more personal stories, tips etc. related to the environment/climate movement
- Users can opt-in to monthly/weekly challenges that earn them virtual trees to plant in their virtual garden when completed.

- Users can follow specific topics to align with their location and interests, preventing them from being overwhelmed by vast amounts of information.

Content Moderation

We value proper education for our users and will therefore moderate the content shared on PANDO, as climate misinformation and disinformation has risen exponentially on many social media platforms.

1

PANDO prohibits the use of discriminatory language towards individuals of any ethnicity, race, gender, etc.

2

Any sharing of known misinformation or disinformation will not be tolerated.

3

All posts must relate to one or more of the following topics: environmental justice, civil rights activism, climate events, etc.



- Users can report/flag content they believe violate the code of conduct.
- An algorithm will be used to scan posts for any outward violations, with human moderators screening flagged content.

Funding Model & Approach

Funding Model: Grant-Funded & Publicly-Owned

-  Pando aims to stay free from exploitative, profit-driven models (e.g. ads, venture capital).
-  Focus is on climate justice, community values, and fact-based discussion — not profit.

Why Not Ads or Investors?

-  Ad-based platforms like Facebook prioritize profits over public interest.
-  Investor-driven models pressure platforms to maximize returns, often at the cost of integrity.
-  Content on these platforms is shaped by algorithms driven by revenue, not truth.

Benefits of Grant + Public Ownership

-  Funded by government grants, NGOs, and sustainability-oriented organizations.
-  Promotes transparency, accountability, and public interest.
-  Aligned with Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs): inclusivity, climate action, and equity.

Empowering the Community

-  Public ownership encourages democratic decision-making.
-  Platform reflects users' values instead of advertiser priorities.
-  Ensures long-term sustainability without needing to chase viral or commercial content.

Challenges/Barriers

Information Validity & Moderation

- Combatting misinformation while remaining an open dialogue space
 - AI moderation + fact-checking + user flagging
 - Human oversight to avoid algorithmic bias (Hjorth & Hinton, 2019; Tufekci, 2017)

User Engagement

- Avoiding passive scrolling by encouraging meaningful interaction
 - Gamified features: sustainability challenges, leaderboards, rewards (Schradie, 2018)

Accessibility

- Digital & linguistic inclusion for marginalized users
 - Low-bandwidth mode + multilingual discussion forums (Ginsburg, 2024)

Funding Sustainability

- Long-term support without corporate influence
 - Partnerships with NGOs, universities, public grants (Barendregt et al., 2021)

Censorship Resistance

- Protecting activist voices in repressive regimes
 - Open-source, decentralized infrastructure enables uncensored access (Shilina, 2023)



Thank you



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